



METEOROLOGIST

JOB DESCRIPTION

Meteorologists study Earth's weather, climate, and atmospheric conditions. In this role, you will use weather data from observation stations, satellite images, and radar to produce short- and long-range weather forecasts for the general public, commercial clients, government agencies, or the military. Meteorologists also play a key role in research into global climate change.



SALARY

Junior meteorologist ★★☆☆☆

Senior meteorologist ★★★★★

INDUSTRY PROFILE

Competitive field • Employers include national weather services, the armed forces, and media and research organizations • Predicted growth in private-sector weather services

▼ RELATED CAREERS

- ▶ **HYDROLOGIST** Monitors, studies, and promotes the sustainable management of water resources, such as lakes, reservoirs, and domestic pipelines. Works for utility firms, government agencies, universities, and environmental consultancies.
- ▶ **OCEANOGRAPHER** Conducts scientific research into the ocean environment, studying how the seas interact with rivers, ice sheets, and the atmosphere. Also provides advice on subjects including currents and tides, marine pollution, and underwater mineral resources to clients such as oil companies and coastal construction firms.

Accurate forecasting relies on the fastest supercomputers in the world, which perform millions of calculations per second to model weather data.

AT A GLANCE



YOUR INTERESTS Earth sciences • Geography • Mathematics • Physics • Chemistry • Biology • Information Technology (IT)



ENTRY QUALIFICATIONS A relevant degree is needed to enter the field, while a postgraduate qualification is necessary to conduct research.



LIFESTYLE Forecasters work in shifts to provide 24-hour cover. Researchers work regular hours, with occasional overtime if necessary.



LOCATION A meteorologist is based in an office at a regional weather station or commercial weather-service provider, at a television studio, or on a military base.



THE REALITIES Meteorologists have a responsibility for accurate forecasting, particularly when severe weather threatens property or lives.